I-Corps Workbook: Week 5

At this point, you should have gathered enough information about and from your customer where organizing your data is key. You'll be able to confirm what you do know about your customer by completing the activities below.

You'll also see what it is that you *don't* know about your customer. Since "those who know their customer best win", the goal is to get a better understanding of your customer so that you know how to best serve them.

Step 1) Create your customer archetype (~10 minutes)

There will be a lot of variability among different potential groups of customers. Would you rather try to understand and sell to 50 significantly different people or 50 people that have a lot in common? It's easier to find a singular value proposition if you find and listen to the way a group of people with **common motivations, pains, gains, and goals** talks about value props.

A customer archetype is a general composite of what a typical customer or end-user looks like and helps define who *is not* the target customer. Here's an example from one of our past I-Corps teams:

Ex. Customer Archetype – Running Coaches

Demographics

- **Job title:** Head coach
- **Age:** 40-60 years old
- **Experience:** 10+ years
- **Education:** Bachelors

Other Important Stuff

- Coach distance running for track or cross country
- Control their own budget
- In "top 20" program, regardless of Division

Motivations/Goals

- **Top motivation:** winning
- **Why winning?** competitiveness, prestige, career advancement
- **Excited about:** seeing individual athletes succeed
- **Why they buy tech products:** confirm their intuitions, but it should not do coaching for them
- **Heroes:** GOAT coaches

Fill out answers to bullet points below about your customer archetype. Go beyond the pre-listed questions to include at least two additional important details about your ideal customer:

*Whatever you know about your customer from interviews, document it below! Dig deeper and ask why. Guesses are totally okay!

Demographics	Psychographics/Motivations/Goals
● Gender: **N/A (maybe male)** ● Age range: **30-60** ● Job title: **Owner, Farmer, Organizer** ● Family/Customer Role: **Organic/Sustainability** ● Geographic location: **NorthEast Ohio** ● Hobbies: **Community Engagement Events**	● What keeps them awake at night?: - **The weight they put on their shoulders alone to not lose everything if they can't function better.** ● What do they fear most? - **That their devotion to make a living is the only thing that can keeps their life from being meaningless and that it might not still be enough** ● What do they get the most excited about? - **The prospect of growing they business and approach, this fuels dreams of community on a common mission.** ● Who is their hero? - **They're hero is Will Haris** ● What publications do they read? - **Local news (not Big media)** ● What is their top priority or #1 problem they want solved? - **Easier to connect with community via business, for their family and friends and their own self worth** ● What motivates them? Cost savings? Peer pressure? Risk aversion? - **They are motivated by idealistic ideas of how they wish to better operate without concession to their vision** ● Where do they look for new products/innovations? - **They likely talk to their similar minded network of individuals as well as podcast and media of interest**

Share your customer archetype with the other participants in your breakout room!

CHECK: Can you easily use your Customer Archetype to identify whether or not a person is your customer? Can you add in any additional details to further define ***who*** your customer is?

Identify your 1-2 riskiest assumptions about your customer archetype

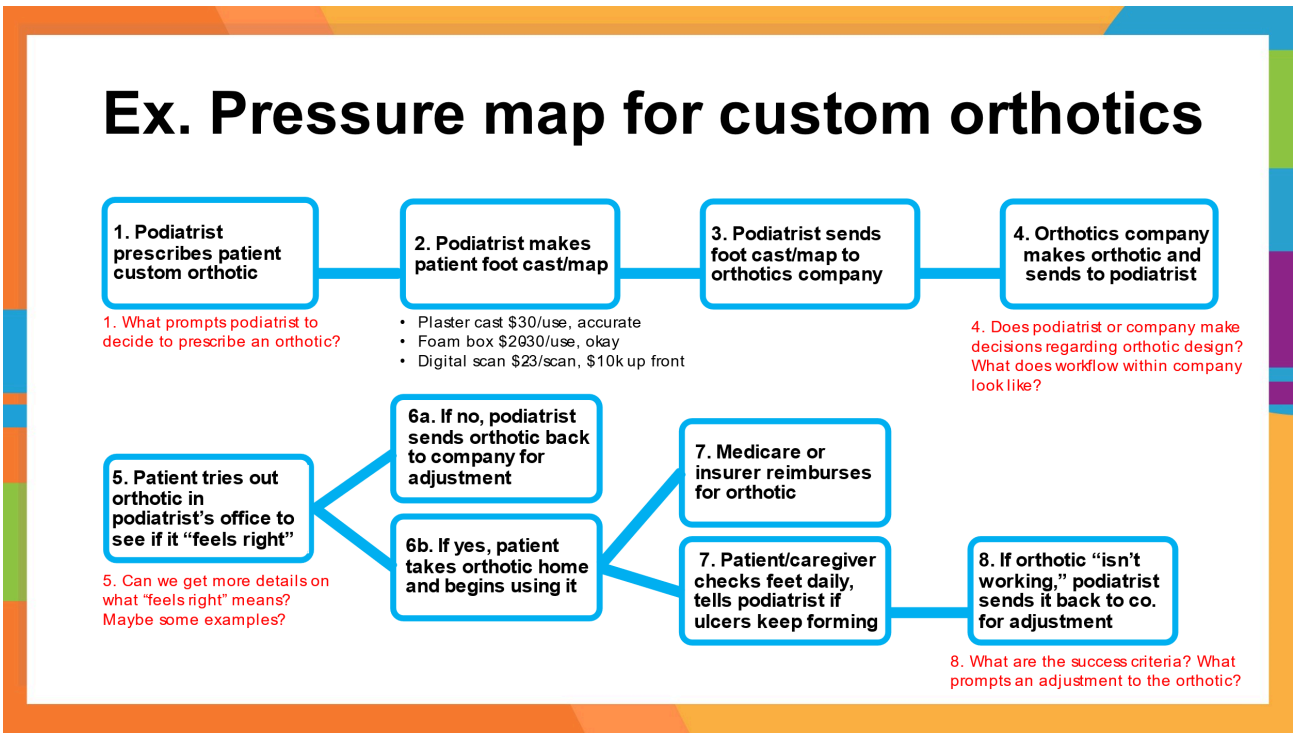
Risky assumption #1: The market segment that they operate in can benefit from greater community connectivity and support of small businesses more than the downsides of similar competitors having the ability to benefit from this as well. (Everyone can Win)

Risky assumption #2: Buyers, Producers, and HUB/CSA organizers make efforts to do business with a priority and pride in quality and health.

If anything in the customer archetype is a **key** business assumption and you're fairly uncertain about it, test it in your upcoming interviews.

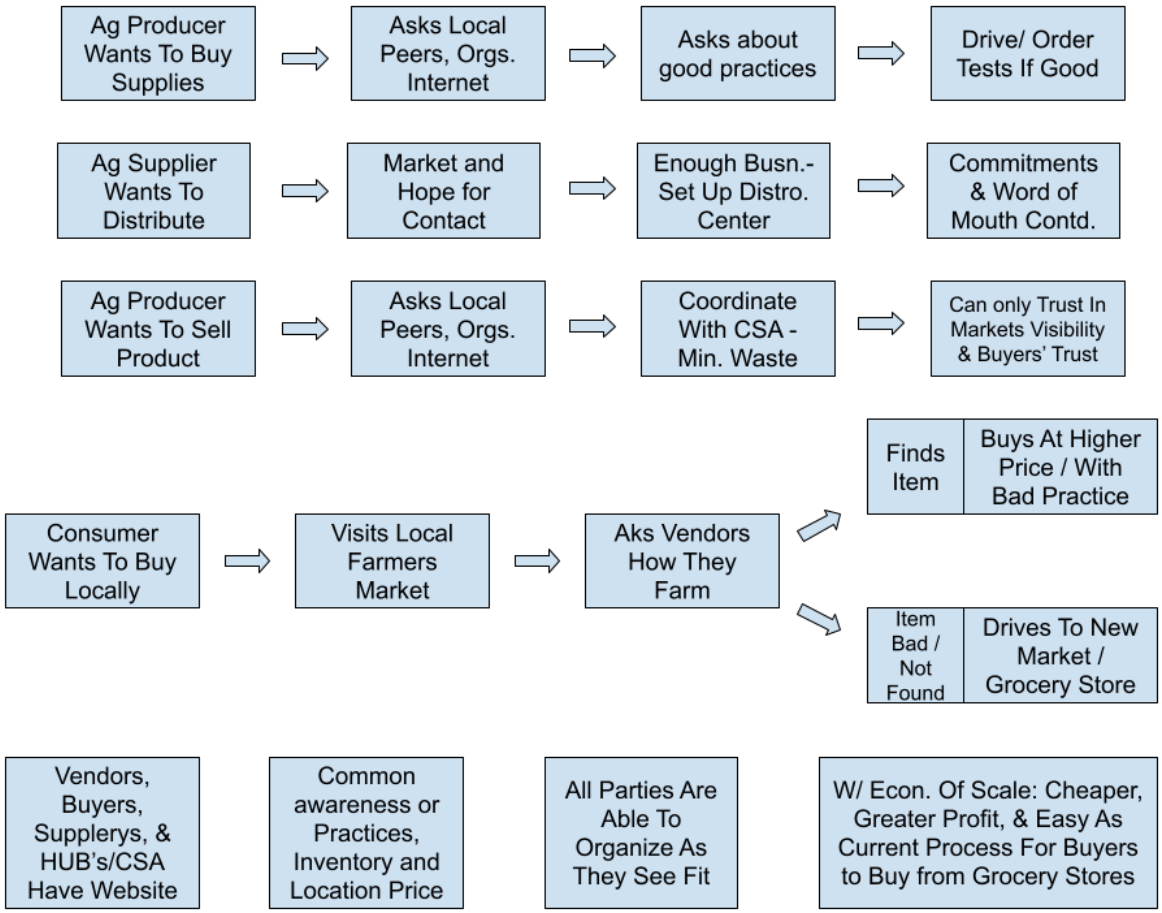
Step 2) Create a customer workflow map (~15 minutes)

A customer workflow map is a visual representation of all of the experiences the customer has from start to finish in order to solve a problem/accomplish a goal. Here's an example from one of our past I-Corps teams:



Be critical of your own work. Try to identify additional steps, leave extra placeholders for unknown steps, and look for splits in the workflow process, which may indicate a need for further segmentation.

Create a workflow map for your team's user experience and paste a screenshot of it over here:



CHECK:

Did you address the following in your map?:

- What people are involved in each step?
- What does each step cost in time and money?
- What are the key decision points? Who makes these decisions?
- How does this workflow change when your solution is adopted?
- Did you leave extra placeholders for unknown steps?

Identify your 1-2 riskiest assumptions about your customer workflow map

Risky assumption #1:

Risky assumption #2:

We expect that several steps in the workflow map will represent **key** business assumptions. Test the most critical assumptions in your upcoming interviews.

Also, remember, that you should still be testing your core hypotheses about customer segment, customer problem and value proposition.

By this point in the program, you should be adding more specifics into your hypotheses to get the most out of your interviews. Be sure to build in quantified details about your customer's behavior, the value they need, or both! Your hypotheses should be growing more and more specific with each week of the program. If you have additional time left in your breakout room, share your current business hypotheses with the other teams in the room, and provide feedback to one another on ways to add more quantification.